ARENA SCHOOL
www.arenaschool.org

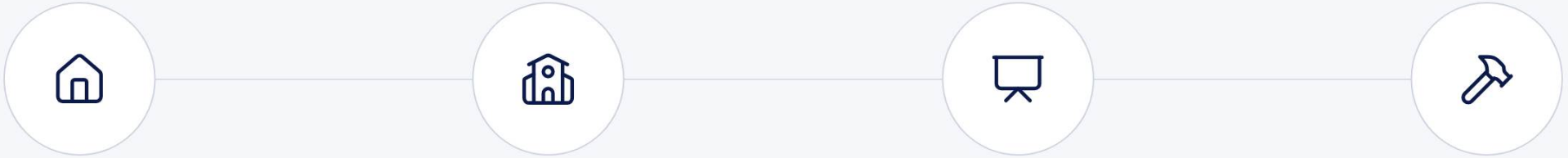
ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program

From what families ask *to what it means for teachers.*



PART 1

What families ask

The ISB parent talk, what employers now want, and what parents ask us

PART 2

How we teach

Our philosophy, learning framework, outcomes, and assessment

PART 3

The proof

The ISB AI Founders week, from day one to demo day

PART 4

For teachers

The ethics, the comfort to build, and a short demo

ABOUT ARENA SCHOOL

AI tools change every week.
We teach learners to make the calls.

MEMBER OF ANTHROPIC *Startup Program* · OpenAI *Partner Network*

WHAT WE DO

Hands-on programs where every learner makes real things with AI.

HOW WE TEACH

- Learners make every decision
- AI does the building
- *Real work for a real audience*

WHO WE WORK WITH

- Students, grades 6 to 12
- Teachers and schools
- Parents and families

OUR TEAM STUDIED AT

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

OUR TEAM WORKED AT

McKinsey&Company · Goldman Sachs · Y · Microsoft AI · Deloitte. · KIMI

PART 1

Families are asking what AI means *for their children's future.*

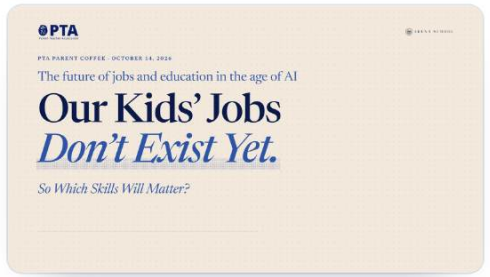
1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

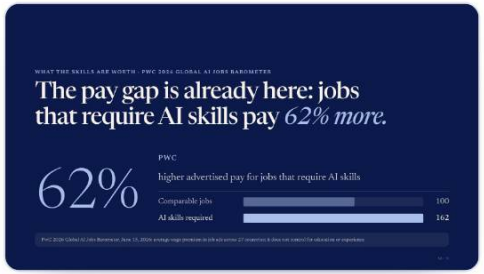
4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

This week, we talked with ISB parents about what is changing at work, *and what their children might practice now.*



THE TALK

Our kids' jobs don't exist yet. So which skills will matter?



WORK IS CHANGING

Job ads that require AI skills offer 62% more pay.



STUDENTS FEEL IT

In China, 91% of graduating students changed plans; 57% are learning AI skills.



WHAT LASTS

Three human skills: agency, taste, and craft.

PwC 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer. China Youth Daily survey of 1,333 graduating students, May 2026.

Many companies now want people who use AI *across the whole job, not only in technical roles.*



AI fluency

Uses AI on everyday work, in any role, not only engineering.



Works with agents

Hands multi-step work to AI agents, then checks what comes back.



Range

Learns new tools fast and works across the whole job.

Many parents hear this at their own workplaces. *So they ask whether their children are learning it.*

WHAT FAMILIES ASK US

Parents are asking one practical question: *which skills will outlast the tools?*

From surveying parents in the ISB community and other local communities in mainland China

WHAT PARENTS CARE ABOUT

Which skills last as the tools change?

Will AI do the thinking for my child?

What should my child practice now?

OUR ANSWER

Three skills that stay useful

Used well, AI deepens thinking

Real products, in five days

Many parents don't see AI as an academic subject, like learning to code.
They see it as a life skill: optional for many jobs today, and likely non-negotiable by the time their children start working.

PART 2

We teach the part of learning *that AI can't do for you.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

THE QUESTION WE TRY TO ANSWER AT ARENA SCHOOL

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

Three human skills AI can't supply.
Without them, AI does the thinking.



01 · CHOOSE

Agency

Choosing what is worth doing, before anyone assigns it.

WITHOUT IT

AI picks the problem, and learners follow.



02 · JUDGE

Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good.

WITHOUT IT

Learners accept the first answer AI gives.



03 · FINISH

Craft

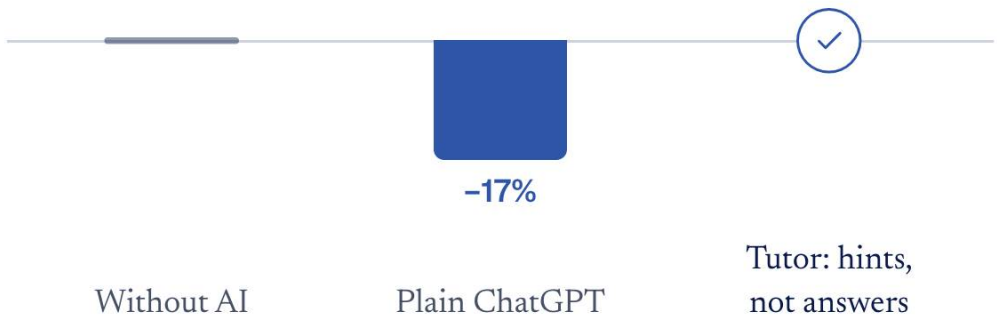
Finishing the work so people can trust it.

WITHOUT IT

The work stays an unchecked first draft.

Both used AI, *but the design shaped the results.*

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · NEARLY 1,000 STUDENTS



–17% exam grades after practicing with plain ChatGPT. The tutor version largely avoided the drop.

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL



2× the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: grades fell 17% once plain ChatGPT was taken away; with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

AI can help at every step of the cycle.
The decisions stay with the learner.

01 Inquiry and planning

Which problem, for whom, and the plan

Suggests angles and drafts the plan

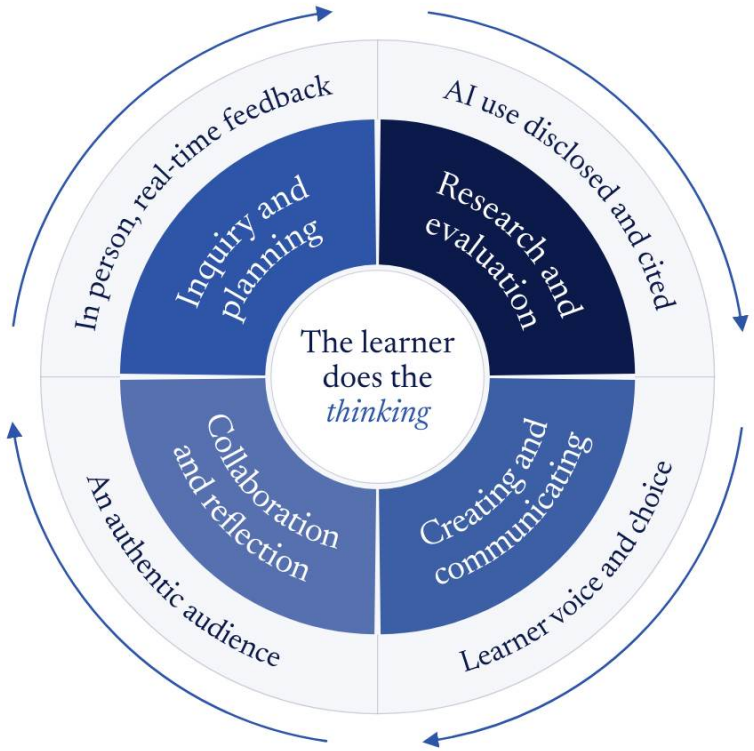
"Why this problem?"

02 Research and evaluation

Which sources and answers to trust

Searches, summarizes, and compares options

"How did you check it?"



04 Collaboration and reflection

What to change after critique

Gives a first round of feedback

"What would you do differently?"

03 Creating and communicating

What to build, and what to cut

Writes the code, drafts, and visuals

"How do you know it's good?"

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Across every program, *learners will be able to...*

Learners are whoever a program is for: students, teachers, school leaders, or parents. The outcomes stay the same; the depth grows.

Inquiry and planning	• Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question. • Plan a project with milestones, and adjust the plan based on progress.
Research and evaluation	• Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output. • Compare options against criteria, and justify a choice. • Explain how AI tools work, where they fail, and the bias and privacy issues they raise.
Creating and communicating	• Build and test a product, prototype, or solution, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it. • Structure an argument and write it clearly, in their own words. • Present to an authentic audience, and defend their reasoning under questioning.
Collaboration and reflection	• Work in a team, share roles, and contribute to a shared product. • Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work. • Reflect on their process and on what they would do differently.

When AI can polish the product, *we assess the thinking behind it.*

THE PRODUCT

What AI can polish

THE THINKING BEHIND IT *What we assess*

IN PRACTICE *Used with ISB students, summer 2026*

Inquiry and planning

Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question.

Research and evaluation

Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output.

Creating and communicating

Build and test a product, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it.

Collaboration and reflection

Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work.

EVIDENCE WE ASSESS

Process journal

Drafts

Recorded defense

PART 3

In five days, ISB students built and launched *working products with AI.*

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

An AI builder week for grades 7 to 12:
learn AI skills, start a company, build something real.

Mentors in the room every day

- Daily feedback on each team's idea
- The same question all week: "How did you check it?"

Guests who build with AI for a living

- Founders, product managers, and designers from tech companies
- Real stories of how AI is changing their work

7–12 grades, selected by application

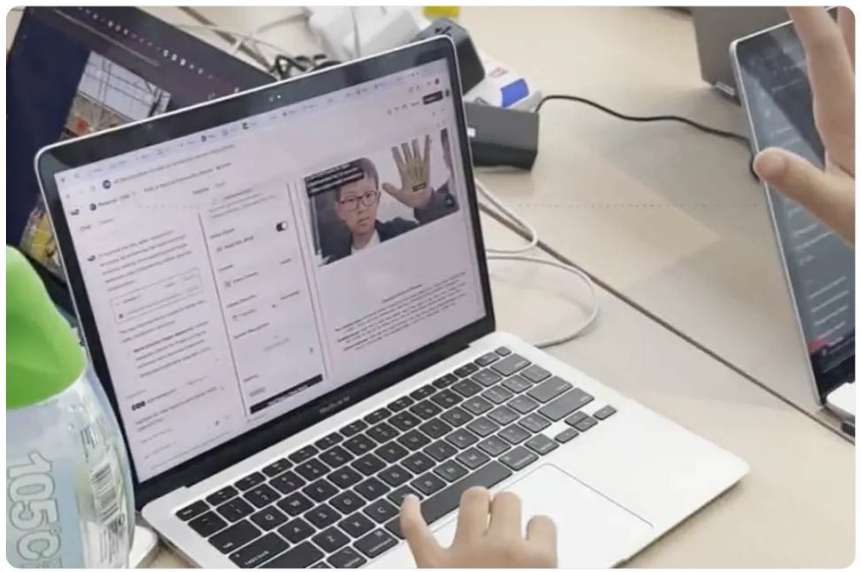
5 days, at ISB in August

0 coding experience required

Ten stages in five days, *and every day ends with something real.*

	DAY 1 Pick a problem	DAY 2 Go public	DAY 3 The rebuild	DAY 4 Polish and price	DAY 5 Demo day
STAGES	*01* Find the idea *02* Validate it *03* Form the team *04* Define it	*05* Design it *06* Build it *07* Ship it live	*08* Test and iterate	*09* Brand it	*10* Pitch and sell
MAIN TOOLS					
SKILL TRAINED	AGENCY	TASTE	TASTE	CRAFT	CRAFT
OUTPUT	*A one-page plan and a first prototype*	*A live link that real people try*	*A rebuilt product, shaped by users*	*A name, a landing page, and a price*	*A two-minute pitch to judges and families*

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 Found the problem AGENCY

He chose the problem himself: his cousin is deaf.

02 Sketched it AGENCY

An app that turns sign language into spoken words.

03 Built it CRAFT

AI wrote the code; he decided what the app should do.

04 Changed it TASTE

His grandmother struggled at first, so he made the audio clearer.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- *Turn an interest into a focused question*
- *Build and test a product*
- *Use critique to revise the work*

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*

The judges tried every product

- Opened and used each one before scoring
- Scored what worked, not the slides

Each team pitched its own work

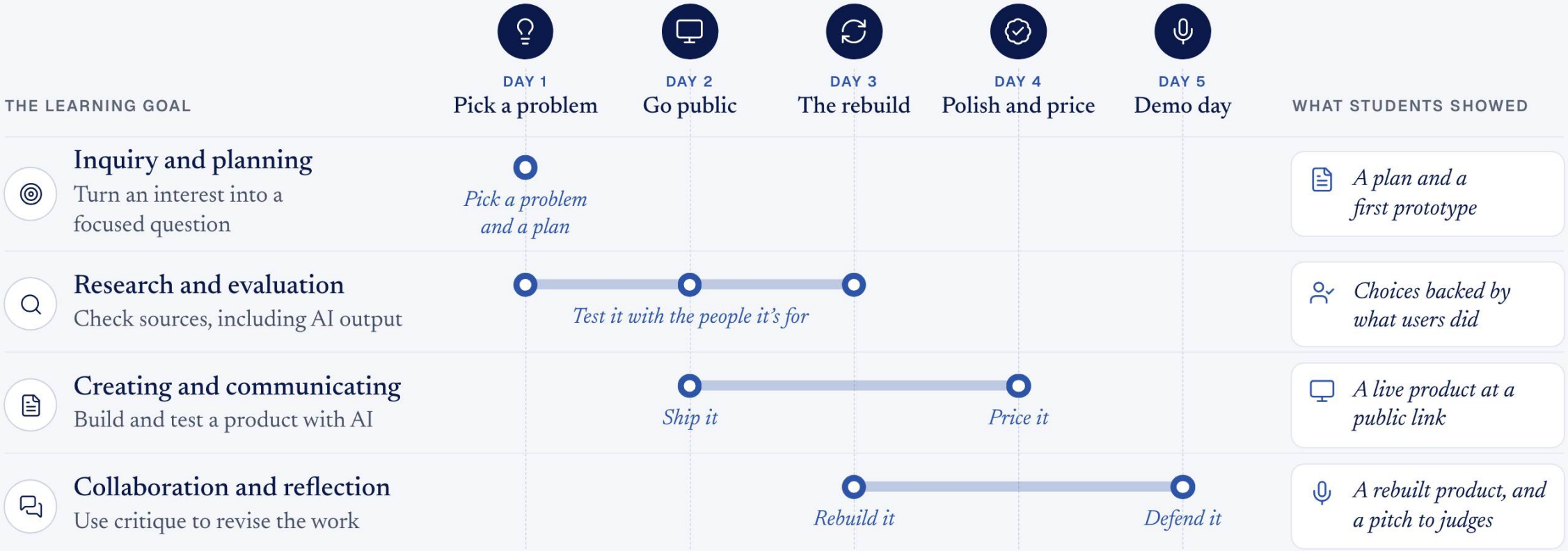
- Two minutes per team
- To judges and families in the room

Then came the hard questions

- From the judges, on the spot
- Why this problem, and why this design

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

Every learning goal, practiced on real work *for real people, in five days.*



Tools change. *The process carries over: find an idea, work as a team, test with real people, and learn from feedback.*

PART 4

Families hope AI shows up across subjects.
So how might it fit in yours?

1 What families ask
The ISB parent talk

2 How we teach
Framework and outcomes

3 The proof
ISB AI Founders week

4 For teachers
Ethics and comfort to build

Two things we've seen help: *the ethics, and the comfort to build.*

Ethics and responsible use

- When AI use is fair, and how students disclose and cite it
- Which tools your school allows, and keeping student data out
- How to assess the process, not only the polished product

Comfort to build

- Has built one small thing with AI, start to finish
- Knows the steps students take: prompt, test, and fix
- Can ask any student, "How did you check it?"

Many students already use these tools outside school. *Knowing what that looks like helps us guide them.*

You don’t need to be a master vibe coder.
It helps to know what your students are doing.

Vibe coding: building software by describing it to AI in plain English

YOU DON’T NEED TO

Build launch-ready apps

Keep up with every new tool

Write code

IT HELPS TO

Build one small tool for your class

Explain how AI predicts likely words

Ask about the process behind their work

Comfortable means you can follow how a student reached the outcome they present.
That’s what lets you coach it, and assess it.

Teachers can build for their own class *without writing code.*

ENGLISH · FROM A TEACHER WE SPOKE WITH

Literary devices, one click away

SONNET 18 · LINES 5–7

METAPHOR

Sometime too hot the eye of heaven shines,

PERSONIFICATION

And often is his gold complexion dimm'd;

ALLITERATION

And every fair from fair sometime declines,

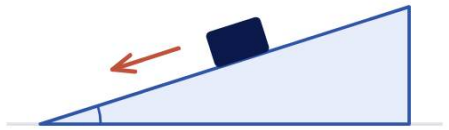
Instead of color-coding a poem by hand at the board, the teacher tags each literary device before class.

In class, one click reveals each device and its label.

Class time goes to discussing the poem.

SCIENCE · WHAT A STEM TEACHER CAN BUILD

A simulation made for this class



Angle **20°**

Friction **0.3**

Students take a model apart and rebuild it, or change one variable in a physics setup.

Built for this lesson, not the nearest YouTube demo.

Students test ideas instead of watching one.

Here's what comfortable looks like: *one sentence, one working tool.*

STEP 1 · YOU SAY IT — AGENCY

One plain sentence

A change to a classroom tool, called out by the room.

"Add a Chinese version of the parent email."

"Add a timer to the quiz."

→

STEP 2 · AI BUILDS IT — CRAFT

Claude Code writes it

An AI tool that builds web apps from plain English.

Claude Code *by Anthropic*

```
› Add a Chinese version of the parent email under the English one.
```

→ *Working in about two minutes*

→

STEP 3 · WE CHECK IT — TASTE

Try it on the big screen

Then ask what we ask students: how did you check it?

"Does the Chinese match the English?"

"Does it change with the tone?"

Coaching matters more with AI, *and three questions go a long way.*

THE TEACHER'S ROLE

From the person with the answers

↓

to the coach who asks the questions

It's what many of you already do, and what our mentors did all week.

01
AGENCY

"Why this problem?"

They choose, not the AI.

02
TASTE

"How do you know it's good?"

They judge what it made.

03
CRAFT

"What would make someone trust it?"

They check it and finish it.

AI can do the making.
The thinking is still ours to teach.



1

Families care

Many parents see AI as a life skill, and ask what children practice.

2

Design matters

Two studies, opposite results. Learners choose, judge, and finish.

3

Students can ship

Live products in five days, no coding required.

4

What helps teachers

The ethics, and enough comfort to build one small tool.

No one here has to be a master "vibe coder." Knowing what your students are doing may be enough to keep coaching them.

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS WELCOME

If this could help your school, *we'd love to hear from you.*

WHAT WE RUN · *three pillars, one framework, planned with your team and run on your campus*

STUDENTS

Build and pitch a real product with AI

Entrepreneurship & AI Intensive
App Design Workshop
College Portfolio Workshop

SCHOOLS AND TECH TEAMS

AI training that works inside your school's rules

AI for Educators
Tech coaches and IT directors

FAMILIES AND COMMUNITY

Honest talks on AI, work, and college

Community Dialogues
Parent coffees and talks

KEEP IN TOUCH · *scan for today's materials, or reach us directly*

Today's slides, checklist, and tool guide

SCAN WITH YOUR PHONE

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